More Solutions On Crit Minerals Problem

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This document builds on the earlier one by outlining more specific solutions. After doing additional research, I gained a better understanding of how complex and far reaching the critical-minerals supply chain is. Please take a look and let me know which areas you think I should explore further.

China's control of critical-mineral processing creates a national security risk. A think tank should use open-source intelligence, trade data, corporate records, satellite imagery, and expert interviews to identify vulnerabilities and evaluate U.S. policy options.

- **Create a Critical-Minerals Risk Monitor**
  - Track Chinese processing capacity, export controls, prices, and estimated stockpiles
  - Identify warning signs of supply restrictions
  - Publish regular risk assessments for policymakers and industry
- **Map China's Foreign Dependencies**
  - Trace lithium imports from Australia, Chile, Argentina, and Africa
  - Map Chinese ownership stakes, contracts, refineries, and shipping routes
  - Identify where allied partnerships could reduce Chinese control
- **Study Allied Supply-Chain Cooperation**
  - Compare the capabilities of Australia, Malaysia, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, and European states
  - Assess whether Pax Silica is producing real coordination
  - Recommend ways to share information and prevent competing or duplicate investments
- **Develop an Investment-Priority Scorecard**
  - Rank projects by production potential, cost, completion time, political risk, and exposure to China
  - Examine Lynas's Malaysian operations and stalled Texas expansion as case studies
  - Identify which projects deserve U.S. financing or purchase guarantees
- **Model Supply-Disruption Scenarios**
  - Simulate Chinese cutoffs of heavy rare earths, gallium, and germanium
  - Test whether Project Vault and allied reserves could sustain key industries
  - Evaluate substitutes such as recycling and Niron's rare-earth-free magnets

The research would give policymakers and intelligence agencies an unclassified evidence base for anticipating Chinese actions and directing limited resources. The goal would be to identify which policies can reduce Beijing's leverage without causing unnecessary economic disruption or military escalation.